

Counselling Service Analysis through Professional Interview



Operational Setting Analyzed

Centre Name: "The Hour Mental Care" (Private Mental Health Practice)

Interviewee: Encik Syafiq (Senior In-House counsellor)

Target Audience: Children, teenagers, adults, up to geriatric patients.

1. Operational Setting & Services Analysis

 150 - 180 Sessions / Month

 70% Face-to-Face

 30% Online



Private Practice vs. Schools

Unlike schools or public universities where counsellors do endless administrative or paperwork tasks, private clinics allow counsellors to focus heavily on clinical therapeutic sessions with clients.



Broad Demographic Scope

The clinic treats individuals of all age groups. Encik Syafiq highlighted that their oldest client was an 84-year-old suffering from geriatric loneliness, demonstrating an expansive, community-wide reach.

"Dulu kita pernah klien kita paling tua 84 tahun... isu adalah just loneliness."

2. Multi-Dimensional Counsellor Roles

The Hybrid counsellor Matrix

In a modern private clinic, a counsellor cannot live purely inside a clinical room. Counsellors must act like agile systems to handle market forces:

Clinical Therapist: Running face-to-face and online sessions.

Marketer & Content Creator: Going live on TikTok daily from 10:30 AM to 12:00 PM to build real-time audience engagement.

Business Specialist: Managing incoming inquiries and working closely with corporate B2B pipelines.

The Clinical Workforce Scale

The firm runs on an organized combination of in-house and on-demand professional assets:

2 In-House Senior counsellors: Managing full clinical paths.

2 Trainee counsellors: Masters and undergrad level interns.

6 Locum counsellors & 8 Locum

Psychologists: External specialists called in based on system bookings.

3. Theoretical & Approaches

Person-Centered Therapy (Carl Rogers)

Encik Syafiq favors Rogerian therapy to offer **Unconditional Positive Regard**. It lets clients vent completely without fear of societal judgment, helping them achieve inner insight ("celik akal").

"You just tanya apa yang klien perlukan and klient vent... kita bagi peluang untuk klien rasa yang dia value dia punya perasaan."

(Rogers, 1957)

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)

Because Person-Centered therapy can lack explicit directions or structure for formal reports, CBT is added to provide explicit architecture. This helps structure thoughts, behavior charts, and weekly homework assignments.

(Corey, 2021)

4. Ethical Considerations



Public Encounters & Dual Relationships

The Reality: Encountering clients unexpectedly in public spaces. Syafiq discovered that a married couple he was counselling for intense marital conflict lived right next door to him!

Ethical Protocol: Protect client autonomy. Never greet or acknowledge the client first in public. If the client says hello first, keep it brief, and discuss the public interaction openly in the next formal session.



Boundaries of Confidentiality

When reporting clinical summaries to parents or third parties, restrict information to generalized overviews of psychological discomfort. Walled-off case details can only be provided under explicit court orders or legal discovery actions.

5. Current Challenges in Practice



Countertransference & Burnout

Syafiq candidly shared an instance where a massive personal argument left him emotionally raw right before starting a session with a client. Managing 150-180 sessions a month leaves counsellors vulnerable to severe compassion fatigue.



Admin Overhead & System Confusion

Even though the practice focuses heavily on clinical sessions, a huge volume of client inquiries creates confusion. Incoming clients frequently lack awareness of psychological roles, showing a clear need for automated intake triage platforms.

"Inquiry client... macam oh saya nak book session saya tak tahu nak book yang mana satu saya nak kaunselor ke clinical psychologist."

6. Actionable System Recommendations

Automated Intake Triage Tool

The Fix: Build an interactive, algorithmic web form that asks clients basic questions before booking. This automatically routes them to either a Licensed counsellor or a Clinical Psychologist based on risk level, taking the administrative burden off staff.

Structured Peer Supervision Blocks

The Fix: Set up mandatory, systemic safeguards for counsellors to prevent compassion fatigue. Build an automated schedule into the clinic's internal system that blocks out peer supervision sessions and self-care gaps after intense trauma cases.

Academic References & Evidence

- Syafiq, E. (2026). Personal interview on private mental health practice operations and counselor roles. [Conducted at Tamarind Square].

